



The Influence of Social Media Influencers on Gen-Z Buying Behavior

Muhammed Zakir Hossain ✉ 

Associate Professor, Department of Business Studies, State University of Bangladesh, Bangladesh

Syed Nabid Uddin 

Department of Business Studies, State University of Bangladesh, Bangladesh

Sinthia Akter 

Department of Business Studies, State University of Bangladesh, Bangladesh

Abstract

In Bangladesh, growing digital penetration and broad adoption of social networking platforms have intensified the influence of social media on young consumers, particularly Generation-Z. Social media influencers have become a crucial factor influencing Gen-Z consumers' purchase intents and consumption patterns as they depend more and more on online personalities for guidance, amusement and product discovery. This context requires empirical research to investigate the extent to which influencer attributes influence the purchasing behaviour of Gen-Z. Therefore the purpose of this study is to examine how three key factors - perceived credibility (PC), content quality (CQ) and parasocial interaction (PSI) affect Gen-Z purchasing behaviour (GZBB) in Bangladesh. Here, the independent variables are PC, CQ and PSI while GZBB is the dependent variable. Following a review of pertinent prior research, a structured questionnaire was created and 350 online survey links were sent via social media platforms utilising a non-probability convenience sample technique. A total of 168 responses were received; 160 genuine cases were retained (n=160) after filtering for completeness. The hypotheses were tested using correlation and regression analyses in SPSS (version 26) at a 5% significance level. The findings show that GenZ purchasing behaviour is significantly and favourably impacted by PC, CQ and PSI. The study concludes by proposing a number of prospective research directions and providing practical implications for digital marketers, brands and influencers.

Keywords: *Social Media Influencers Perceived Credibility (PC), Content Quality (CQ), Parasocial Interaction (PSI), Gen-Z Buying Behavior (GZBB).*

JEL Classification codes: *M31, M37, M39.*

Suggested citation: Hossain, M.Z., Uddin, S.N., & Akter, S. (2026). The Influence of Social Media Influencers on Gen-Z Buying Behavior. *European Journal of Management, Economics and Business*, 3(3), 155-166. DOI: 10.59324/ejmeb.2026.3(3).11

Introduction

The sudden surge of the digital world and social networking sites has radically changed the nature of marketing communication in the modern world, especially to the younger generations in the consumer market. Social media has now become a powerful platform where sharing of



information, entertainment and commercial persuasion come together, to enable brands to interact with consumers more interactively and personally. In the same environment, social media influencers have become a formidable influence of opinion leaders who can influence the consumer attitude through sharing experiences, lifestyle content and product recommendations among masses of online users (Octaviani et al., 2023). Their growing prominence has reshaped traditional advertising frameworks, positioning influencer marketing as a strategic approach for guiding consumer decision-making. Generation Z is the most digitally engaged consumer generation, as it has experienced social media and mobile technology as it grew up. This generation uses a considerable amount of time on platforms like Facebook, Instagram, YouTube and TikTok and the content created by an influencer is a key element in product discovery and brand assessment (Nguyen et al., 2022). Gen-Z consumers are more distrustful of standard advertising and favor peer-like endorsement, which comes via influencers who are seen as credible, authentic, and relatable than previous generations. Therefore, marketers are turning more and more to influencer-led campaigns as a way of reaching Gen-Z consumers and influencing their purchasing decisions (Kumar et al., 2024).

The persuasive power of influencers is based on a number of attributes that are interrelated, such as perceived credibility, the quality of the content they create and the emotional bond they form with the followers. Reliable influencers are usually perceived as credible and informed, making their endorsements persuasive. Equally, quality material that is visually appealing, informative and engaging will enhance audience attention and effectiveness of the message. In addition to these functional features, influencers have also developed parasocial interactions, one-sided emotional relationships that make them feel close and familiar to the followers which further make them more influential in the consumer behavior (Kholkina et al., 2024). All of these processes are the reasons why influencer marketing has become especially efficient with Gen-Z consumers.

The social media impact has expanded at a very high rate in Bangladesh because of the availability of the internet, the high rate of smart phones usage, and the young population who is highly active in the sphere of the digital world. The culture of influencers has grown to cover a wide range of different products, including fashion and beauty, technology and lifestyle making influencers a valuable source of information to young consumers (Táborecká-Petrovičová et al., 2023). Bangladeshi Gen-Z users are becoming more and more dependent on influencers both as a source of entertainment and decision making with regard to their purchases. Nevertheless, in spite of this increased topicality, there is limited empirical literature that investigates the influence of influencer characteristics on Gen-Z purchasing behavior in Bangladesh, especially in comparison to studies done in developed economies (Ashdaq et al., 2024).

Previous studies in Bangladesh have mostly paid attention to more general digital marketing questions like uptake of e-commerce, online trust and overall consumer behavior which creates a significant knowledge gap on the effects of influencers and followers and their behavioral consequences (Malik et al., 2023). Furthermore, although previous research has recognized the significance of influencer credibility and content strategies, fewer studies consider relational variables including parasocial interaction and content-related determinants in a developing nation. This gap has to be addressed as the unique consumption patterns and media habits of the Bangladeshi Gen-Z consumers.

It is against this background that the current study aims at investigating the role that perceived credibility (PC), content quality (CQ) and parasocial interaction (PSI) play in fostering Gen-Z buying behavior (GZBB) in Bangladesh. To be more precise, the research question that will be answered in the context of the study are as follows: To what extent is perceived credibility, content quality and parasocial interaction influential on the Gen-Z buying behavior in Bangladesh?



This research has a number of significant contributions to the literature. First, it offers empirical data regarding influencer marketing efficacy in a developing-country setting in which Gen-Z constitutes an impetus of a fast-growing consumer group. Second, it incorporates the credibility, content and relational dimensions into one analytical concept to understand Gen-Z purchasing behavior. Lastly, the results provide valuable insights to marketers, brands and influencers aiming to develop more effective influencer-based strategies in Bangladesh. The rest of the paper is structured in the following way: relevant literature review and hypothesis elaboration then methodology, results, discussion and concluding remarks with recommendations to future research.

Literature Review

This part will examine the literature and research findings on the topic of social media influencer marketing and its effect on Gen-Z purchasing behavior, specifically the perceived credibility (PC), content quality (CQ) and parasocial interaction (PSI). With the social media platforms having turned into the core of communication and consumption behaviors, the concept of influencer marketing has become one of the most prevalent types of promotional strategies, particularly among younger audiences. In emerging markets, like Bangladesh, where the speed of digital adoption is rapidly growing, it is more and more significant to know how the set of attributes of influencers determines buying behavior.

The influencer marketing theory is based on the assumption that a person who has a large number of followers on the Internet can affect the attitude and behavior of the audience by means of persuasion. Previous studies indicate that Gen-Z consumers, in particular, are particularly vulnerable to the power of influencers because of their high usage of social media and the more peer-to-peer style of communication compared to conventional advertising messages (Chen et al., 2024). The influencers serve as the bridges between the brands and consumers, as they introduce products in contexts that consumers can relate to, thus making advertising less invasive. Nonetheless, the success of influencer marketing will greatly be determined by how the followers rate the credibility of the influencer, the quality of the content presented and the type of emotional connection established with the audience.

Perceived credibility is a well-known key determinant of persuasive communication in the marketing context. The concept of influencer credibility is often defined in terms of trustworthiness, expertise and authenticity which have a cumulative impact on the confidence of followers in the information presented (Balaban & Mustăţea, 2019). Influencers who are seen to have credibility will have their endorsements accepted as reliable and informative more than promotional. It has been empirically shown that believable influencers can increase the message acceptance and have a positive impact on purchase intentions, especially with digitally savvy consumers capable of detecting sponsored content (Garg & Bakshi, 2024). Influencer credibility is an important signal that should denote whether a recommendation should be taken into consideration by Gen-Z consumers who tend to be more skeptical of obvious advertising. Research also indicates that open disclosure and coherent action enhances credibility perceptions, thus making influencer-based buying behavior more likely (Gökerik, 2024).

Another crucial factor determining the success of influencer marketing is the quality of the content. Content quality is how visually, informative, creative and relevant to the interests of the audience influencer-generated posts are. Good quality of content would increase the level of user engagement as it would attract attention and enable understanding of the message (Kim et al., 2024). The existing studies prove that Gen-Z customers are especially sensitive to aesthetically pleasing and emotionally involving content that can meet their values and lifestyle considerations



(Hoang & HUA, 2024). Consistently providing well-organized, relatable and value-based content, influencers have a better chance of maintaining the attention of the followers and making them develop a positive brand perception. Empirical research indicates that content quality can not only enhance engagement but also enhance the attitudes of the consumers to endorsed products and enhance purchase intentions (Chetioui et al., 2020). Consequently, the quality of content is regarded as one of the major contributors to influence by influencers in affecting purchasing behavior.

In addition to the credibility and content attributes, the relationship between the influencers and followers is a key element in shaping consumer behavior. Parasocial interaction is one sided emotional interaction in which followers interact with the media personalities and have feelings of closeness, familiarity and perceived friendship with the media personalities (Jin et al., 2021). Social media platforms amplify parasocial interaction as it allows influencers to use personal experiences, communicate with their followers through comments and live shows and show edited examples of their daily lives. Such engagements give the impression of intimacy which increases emotional attachment and trust. It has been proposed that a robust parasocial relationship leads to a higher degree of receptivity to influence recommendations as the consumer tends to embrace the views and behaviors recommended by the individual he or she feels emotionally attached to (Candra, 2023).

The influence of parasocial interaction on the purchasing behaviour is increased among the GenZ consumers, especially because they view influencers as their peers, not celebrities (Aldousari, 2024). Empirical research shows that parasocial interaction reinforces the credibility of the influencer, brings about greater brand attachment and positive purchase intentions (Herrera et al., 2023). Followers will be more likely to believe the recommendations given by influencers when they are emotionally attached to them and apply such belief to real purchasing behaviors. This reciprocal process makes influencer marketing different from the conventional celebrity endorsements and the significance of the emotional appeal in online persuasion.

Despite the abundant amount of research conducted on the topic of influencer marketing in developed markets, little empirical research has been conducted on developing nations like Bangladesh. The current research in Bangladesh has mostly centered on the overall adoption of digital marketing or e-commerce, which does not provide much information on the specifics of the influencer among Gen-Z customers (Malik et al., 2023). With the swift expansion of the influencer culture and the growing buying capacity of Gen-Z in Bangladesh, the necessity to study the factors of credibility, content quality and parasocial interaction in a single framework is obvious. To fill this gap, this paper will focus on the combined effect of these three determinants of influencer on Gen-Z purchasing behavior, thus adding to a more detailed picture of how influencer marketing is effective in developing digital markets.

Objectives and Hypotheses Development

The main aim of the paper is to discuss whether the three independent variables namely perceived credibility (PC), content quality (CQ) and parasocial interaction (PSI) have significant effects on Gen-Z buying behavior (GZBB) in Bangladesh. Despite the extensive global awareness of influencer marketing, there is a shortage of research on the role of these factors in affecting consumption choices of Bangladeshi Gen-Z users, one of the highest-digital consumer groups in the nation. The current research is based on the hypotheses which are based on previous empirical data and theoretical insights, connecting the influencer related factors to behavioral reactions of young consumers. Based on the literature review, the following hypotheses are advanced:

H1: Perceived credibility (PC) has a significant impact on Gen-Z buying behavior (GZBB).

H2: Content quality (CQ) has a significant impact on Gen-Z buying behavior (GZBB).

H3: Parasocial interaction (PSI) has a significant impact on Gen-Z buying behavior (GZBB).



Research Model of the Study

The research model, grounded in the identified variables and hypotheses, posits that perceived credibility, content quality, and parasocial interaction jointly shape the purchasing behavior of Gen-Z in Bangladesh.

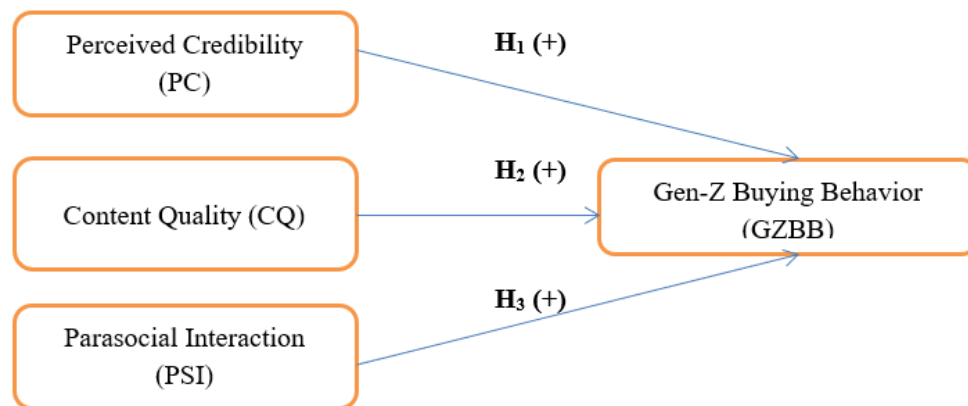


Figure 1. Research Model of the Study

Methodology

The purpose of this study is to explore the influence of perceived credibility (PC), content quality (CQ), and parasocial interaction (PSI) on Gen-Z buying behavior (GZBB) in Bangladesh. To fulfill this objective, the study targeted Bangladeshi Gen-Z consumers who actively follow social media influencers and frequently engage with influencer-generated content on platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, and TikTok. A non-probability convenience sampling method was applied, as the exact number of Gen-Z social media users who regularly interact with influencers could not be identified during the data collection phase. A structured questionnaire was developed based on validated scales adopted from previous studies and distributed online via Google Forms.

A total of 350 survey links were circulated through social networking platforms and messaging applications. Out of these, 168 responses were received, and after the removal of incomplete or inconsistent responses, 160 valid questionnaires were retained for further analysis ($n = 160$). The questionnaire contained two sections. The first section collected demographic information such as age, gender, education level, and social media usage patterns. The second section consisted of Likert-scale items measuring the study variables, where “5” indicated “strongly agree,” “3” indicated “neutral,” and “1” indicated “strongly disagree.”

To ensure reliability, constructs were adapted from established literature. Perceived Credibility (PC) was measured using four items adopted from prior influencer marketing studies and produced a Cronbach Alpha value of 0.831, indicating strong reliability. Content Quality (CQ) was measured using four items adapted from studies on social media content effectiveness and yielded a Cronbach Alpha score of 0.812. Parasocial Interaction (PSI) was measured using five items adapted from parasocial relationship scales and demonstrated a Cronbach Alpha value of 0.846. The dependent variable, Gen-Z Buying Behavior (GZBB), was measured using three items adopted from consumer behavior literature and produced a Cronbach Alpha value of 0.795, which is considered acceptable. All reliability thresholds exceeded the recommended minimum value of $\alpha \geq 0.70$.



SPSS (version 26) was used to conduct descriptive analysis, correlation analysis, and regression analysis. Demographic results were generated to present respondent characteristics, while regression analysis was performed to test the hypotheses at the 5% significance level. Multicollinearity was assessed using tolerance and VIF values, following the same methodological approach used in the model study. The results are presented in the next section.

Results

Demographic Statistics of Respondents

The respondents of this study were Bangladeshi Gen-Z social media users aged between 18 and 26 years ($n = 160$). Table 1 presents the demographic characteristics of the participants. Out of the total respondents, 58% were female and 42% were male, reflecting the higher participation rate of young women in influencer-driven online engagement. Regarding age distribution, 62% of respondents were between 18–22 years, while 38% were between 23–26 years. In terms of education, the majority of respondents (66%) were undergraduate students, 24% were college-level students (HSC), and 10% were postgraduate students. Considering daily social media usage, 73% of respondents reported spending 3–5 hours per day on social media, whereas 19% spent more than 5 hours, indicating a high level of digital engagement typical of Gen-Z users.

Table 1. Demographic Information of Gen-Z Respondents

Demographic Information	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Age		
18–22 years	99	61.9
23–26 years	61	38.1
Gender		
Male	67	41.9
Female	93	58.1
Education Level		
Higher Secondary (HSC)	38	23.8
Undergraduate	105	65.6
Postgraduate	17	10.6
Daily Social Media Use		
1–3 hours	12	7.5
3–5 hours	117	73.1
More than 5 hours	31	19.4

Correlation Analysis

Table 2 presents the correlation matrix between the dependent variable (GZBB) and independent variables (PC, CQ, PSI). All three independent variables show statistically significant correlations with Gen-Z buying behavior at the 1% significance level.

The results indicate that parasocial interaction (PSI) has the strongest correlation with GZBB ($r = 0.428$), followed by perceived credibility (PC) ($r = 0.392$) and content quality (CQ) ($r = 0.367$). This suggests that emotional and relational bonds with influencers may have a slightly stronger effect on buying behavior than content features or credibility alone.

Table 2. Correlation Analysis

Variables	Mean	GZBB	PC	CQ	PSI
1. Gen-Z Buying Behavior (GZBB)	4.0187	1	–	–	–
2. Perceived Credibility (PC)	4.1125	0.392**	1	–	–



3. Content Quality (CQ)	4.2081	0.367**	0.521**	1	–
4. Parasocial Interaction (PSI)	3.9543	0.428**	0.446**	0.498**	1

Note: Correlation significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed); n = 160.

Hypotheses Testing and Regression Analysis

A multiple regression analysis was conducted to examine the impact of PC, CQ, and PSI on GZBB. The Durbin-Watson value is 1.661, which falls within the acceptable range (1.5–2.5), indicating no autocorrelation concerns. Multicollinearity diagnostics show that all VIF values are below 5, confirming no multicollinearity issues.

The regression model explains 34.8% of the variance in Gen-Z buying behavior ($R^2 = 0.348$), which is appropriate for behavioral studies. All three independent variables significantly influence GZBB at the 5% level.

Table 3. Regression Analysis

Independent Variables	β Value	t-value	Sig.	Tolerance	VIF
Perceived Credibility (PC)	0.241	2.985	0.003**	0.578	1.730
Content Quality (CQ)	0.216	2.671	0.008**	0.594	1.683
Parasocial Interaction (PSI)	0.309	3.912	0.000***	0.702	1.425

Note: $R^2 = 0.348$. Durbin-Watson = 1.661. Dependent variable: Gen-Z Buying Behavior (GZBB). $p < 0.05$, * $p < 0.01$ (n = 160).

Regression Model with Standardized Coefficients

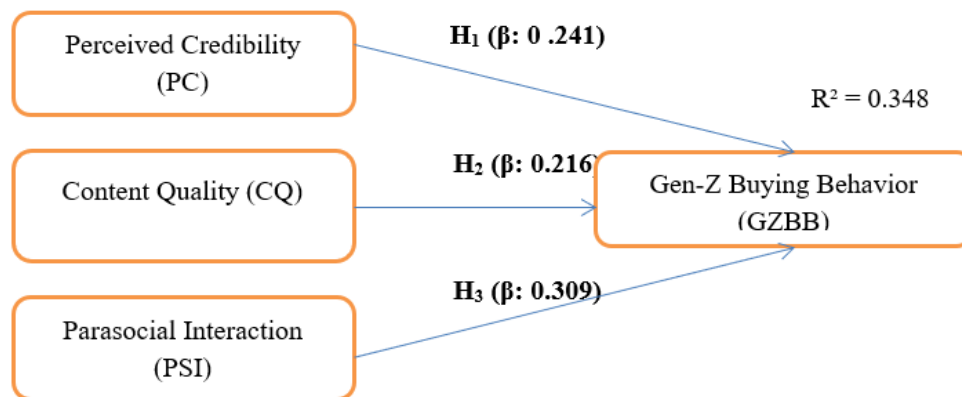


Figure 2. Result analysis of regression coefficient

Table 4. Summary of Hypothesis Testing

Hypothesis	Statement	Decision
H1	Perceived credibility has a significant impact on GZBB	Accepted
H2	Content quality has a significant impact on GZBB	Accepted
H3	Parasocial interaction has a significant impact on GZBB	Accepted

All hypotheses are supported.



Discussion and Implications

The objective of this study was to examine how perceived credibility (PC), content quality (CQ), and parasocial interaction (PSI) influence Gen-Z buying behavior (GZBB) in Bangladesh. The findings provide strong empirical support for the proposed research model and confirm that social media influencers play a significant role in shaping purchase-related decisions among Bangladeshi Gen-Z consumers. By integrating credibility, content, and relational dimensions, the study advances the understanding of influencer marketing effectiveness in a developing-country context where digital engagement is rapidly intensifying.

The results demonstrate that perceived credibility has a significant and positive effect on Gen-Z buying behavior, thereby supporting Hypothesis 1. The correlation analysis shows a moderate but meaningful positive relationship between PC and GZBB ($r = 0.392$, $p < 0.01$), while the regression analysis further confirms this influence with a standardized beta coefficient of $\beta = 0.241$ ($t = 2.985$, $p = 0.003$). These findings indicate that when influencers are perceived as trustworthy, knowledgeable, and authentic, Gen-Z consumers are more inclined to follow their product recommendations. This outcome aligns with source credibility theory, which suggests that message acceptance increases when the communicator is perceived as reliable and expert (Balaban & Mustăţea, 2019). In line with prior empirical evidence, credible influencers reduce advertising skepticism and enhance confidence in endorsed products, particularly among Gen-Z consumers who are highly aware of persuasive intent (Garg & Bakshi, 2024).

The findings also reveal that content quality significantly influences Gen-Z buying behavior, supporting Hypothesis 2. The positive correlation between CQ and GZBB ($r = 0.367$, $p < 0.01$) and the statistically significant regression coefficient ($\beta = 0.216$, $t = 2.671$, $p = 0.008$) suggest that well-crafted, visually appealing, and informative content plays an important role in stimulating purchase behavior. This result reinforces existing research indicating that high-quality influencer content enhances engagement, improves message recall, and strengthens favorable brand evaluations (Chetoui et al., 2020). For Gen-Z consumers, who are exposed to large volumes of digital content daily, influencers who deliver creative and relevant posts are more likely to capture attention and influence buying decisions (Hoang & HUA, 2024). Thus, content quality functions as a key mechanism through which influencer messages translate into behavioral outcomes.

Among the three independent variables, parasocial interaction emerges as the strongest predictor of Gen-Z buying behavior, providing robust support for Hypothesis 3. PSI exhibits the highest correlation with GZBB ($r = 0.428$, $p < 0.01$) and the largest standardized beta coefficient in the regression model ($\beta = 0.309$, $t = 3.912$, $p < 0.001$). This finding highlights the dominant role of emotional and relational bonds in influencer-driven persuasion. Parasocial interaction creates a sense of intimacy and perceived friendship, which increases followers' trust and willingness to adopt influencers' recommendations (Jin et al., 2021). For Gen-Z consumers in Bangladesh, influencers are often viewed as relatable peers rather than distant celebrities, making these one-sided emotional relationships particularly influential (Aldousari, 2024). The strong effect of PSI suggests that emotional connection may outweigh purely informational cues in shaping Gen-Z purchase behavior.

Collectively, the regression model explains 34.8% of the variance in Gen-Z buying behavior ($R^2 = 0.348$), which is considered substantial in behavioral research. This indicates that influencer-related attributes jointly play a meaningful role in shaping consumption decisions among young consumers. The findings also demonstrate that while credibility and content quality are important, relational factors such as parasocial interaction exert a comparatively stronger influence. This reinforces the notion that influencer marketing effectiveness extends beyond message delivery to include emotional engagement and perceived social closeness (Herrera et al., 2023).



From a theoretical perspective, this study contributes to influencer marketing literature by empirically validating a multidimensional framework that integrates credibility, content, and parasocial interaction within a developing-country context. While prior studies have largely focused on developed markets, the present findings confirm that similar mechanisms operate in Bangladesh, albeit with heightened importance placed on emotional connection. By demonstrating that PSI is the strongest predictor of buying behavior, the study extends existing research on digital persuasion and highlights the relational nature of influencer effectiveness (Vrontis et al., 2021).

The findings also offer important managerial implications for brands, marketers, and influencers operating in Bangladesh. First, the significant impact of perceived credibility suggests that brands should carefully select influencers who demonstrate authenticity, expertise, and transparency. Collaborations with influencers who maintain consistent values and disclose sponsored content honestly are more likely to generate trust and positive behavioral responses among Gen-Z consumers (Gökerik, 2024). Second, the positive effect of content quality indicates that influencer campaigns should prioritize creativity, relevance, and informational value rather than excessive promotional messaging. High-quality content enhances engagement and strengthens the persuasive impact of endorsements.

Most importantly, the strong influence of parasocial interaction implies that influencers should actively cultivate emotional connections with their followers. Practices such as sharing personal experiences, engaging in two-way communication, and presenting relatable lifestyle content can deepen followers' sense of intimacy and loyalty. For brands, this suggests that long-term partnerships with influencers may be more effective than short-term promotional campaigns, as sustained interaction strengthens parasocial bonds and increases purchase likelihood.

Overall, the discussion underscores that influencer marketing effectiveness among Bangladeshi Gen-Z consumers is driven not only by what influencers say, but also by how they connect emotionally with their audience. By empirically demonstrating the differentiated effects of credibility, content quality, and parasocial interaction, this study provides a nuanced understanding of how influencer attributes shape youth buying behavior in an emerging digital market.

Conclusion

This study set out to examine the influence of perceived credibility (PC), content quality (CQ), and parasocial interaction (PSI) on Gen-Z buying behavior (GZBB) in Bangladesh. Drawing from the results of correlation and regression analyses, the findings demonstrate that all three independent variables are significant and positive determinants of Gen-Z buying behavior. The study reveals that influencers who exhibit higher credibility, produce superior content, and maintain stronger parasocial bonds with their audience tend to exert greater persuasive power over the purchasing decisions of Bangladeshi Gen-Z consumers. These results align with the growing body of empirical evidence suggesting that influencer marketing plays a pivotal role in shaping consumer attitudes, especially within digitally active youth markets. The observed relationships confirm that influencer-driven marketing strategies can be particularly effective when influencers are viewed as authentic, relatable, and emotionally engaging.

Furthermore, the study highlights the growing significance of influencer culture in Bangladesh, where social media consumption is rapidly increasing among young users. As Gen-Z consumers continue to rely on influencers for entertainment, lifestyle inspiration, and product recommendations, businesses have an opportunity to leverage these digital personalities to strengthen market presence and enhance brand communication. The findings suggest that the more Gen-Z perceives influencers as credible sources, connects emotionally with them, and values the



quality of their content, the more likely they are to engage in influencer-driven purchasing behaviors.

Overall, this study adds to the limited empirical research on influencer marketing in Bangladesh and provides a foundation for understanding how influencer attributes shape youth buying behavior in developing digital markets. By establishing the significant roles of PC, CQ, and PSI, the research contributes valuable insights for marketers, brands, and academics seeking to comprehend or utilize influencer marketing more effectively.

Future Research Directions

While the study offers meaningful insights, it also presents several limitations that open avenues for future research. First, the study employed a quantitative research design and relied solely on self-reported survey data. Future researchers may incorporate qualitative methods, such as interviews or focus groups, to gain deeper insights into the motivations and emotional processes underlying Gen-Z's responses to influencers. Second, the current study measured the effects of only three variables on buying behavior. Future studies may expand the model by including additional factors such as influencer–follower value congruence, social media engagement intensity, or brand–influencer fit, which may provide more comprehensive explanations of consumer behavior.

Third, this study focused exclusively on Gen-Z consumers in Bangladesh, which may limit the generalizability of the findings. Future research could adopt cross-country comparative approaches or examine other demographic groups, such as millennials or middle-aged consumers, to broaden the scope of understanding influencer marketing dynamics. Additionally, considering the fast-changing nature of digital platforms, future studies should examine how emerging technologies—such as virtual influencers, AI-generated content, or augmented reality—shape consumer perceptions and decision-making. These research directions will help broaden the theoretical and practical understanding of influencer marketing in digital consumer environments.

Reference

- Aldousari, A. (2024). Exploring influenceability: Key factors shaping the effectiveness of social media influencer endorsements. *AJAS*, 31(1), 101–135. <https://doi.org/10.34120/ajas.v31i1.1165>
- Ashdaq, M., Jamil, M., & Mandasari, N. (2024). Impact of social media marketing on Gen Z women's buying interest through brand attitude and brand equity in cosmetic products. *Manajemen Dan Kewirausahaan*, 5(1), 61–74. <https://doi.org/10.53682/mk.v5i1.9065>
- Balaban, D., & Mustăţea, M. (2019). Users' perspective on the credibility of social media influencers in Romania and Germany. *Romanian Journal of Communication and Public Relations*, 21(1), 31–46. <https://doi.org/10.21018/rjcp.2019.1.269>
- Candra, W. (2023). The effect of social media influencer characteristics on purchase intention on beauty products in Indonesia. *Iqtishoduna*, 19(2), 133–157. <https://doi.org/10.18860/iq.v19i2.22544>
- Chen, Y., Qin, Z., Yan, Y., & Yi, H. (2024). The power of influencers: How does influencer marketing shape consumers' purchase intentions? *Sustainability*, 16(13), Article 5471. <https://doi.org/10.3390/su16135471>



- Chetioui, Y., Benlafqih, H., & Lebdaoui, H. (2020). How fashion influencers contribute to consumers' purchase intention. *Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management: An International Journal*, 24(3), 361–380. <https://doi.org/10.1108/jfmm-08-2019-0157>
- Filieri, R., & McLeay, F. (2013). E-WOM and accommodation. *Journal of Travel Research*, 53(1), 44–57. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0047287513481274>
- Garg, M., & Bakshi, A. (2024). Exploring the impact of beauty vloggers' credible attributes, parasocial interaction, and trust on consumer purchase intention in influencer marketing. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, 11(1), Article 2760. <https://doi.org/10.1057/s41599-024-02760-9>
- Gökerik, M. (2024). Consumer cynicism in influencer marketing: An impact analysis on purchase intention and brand loyalty. *İnsan Ve Toplum Bilimleri Araştırmaları Dergisi*, 13(1), 404–421. <https://doi.org/10.15869/itobiad.1422438>
- Herrera, L., Valencia-Arias, A., Gallegos, A., Benjumea-Arias, M., & Siapo, E. (2023). Technology acceptance factors of e-commerce among young people: An integration of the technology acceptance model and theory of planned behavior. *Heliyon*, 9(6), Article e16418. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.heliyon.2023.e16418>
- Hoang, V., & Hua, L. (2024). Decoding digital persuasion: A multi-dimensional analysis of social media influencers' impact on consumer purchase intentions in the beauty industry. *International Journal of Economics, Business and Management Research*, 8(9), 372–396. <https://doi.org/10.51505/ijebmr.2024.8922>
- Iqbal, A., Ramish, M., Shoaib, S., & Abbasi, M. (2024). From influence to purchase: Unraveling the impact of influencer credibility, brand involvement, and influencer professionalism on perceived quality and trust-driven purchase intention. *Research Journal for Societal Issues*, 6(2), 832–851. <https://doi.org/10.56976/rjsi.v6i2.265>
- Jin, S. V., Ryu, E., & Muqaddam, A. (2021). I trust what she's #endorsing on Instagram: Moderating effects of parasocial interaction and social presence in fashion influencer marketing. *Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management: An International Journal*, 25(4), 665–681. <https://doi.org/10.1108/jfmm-04-2020-0059>
- Kholkina, V., Chesnokova, E., & Zelenskaya, E. (2024). Virtual or human? The impact of the influencer type on Gen Z consumer outcomes. *Journal of Product & Brand Management*, 34(1), 104–118. <https://doi.org/10.1108/jpbm-12-2023-4885>
- Kim, M., Kim, H., Ma, Z., & Lee, S. (2024). What makes consumers purchase social media influencers endorsed organic food products. *Cornell Hospitality Quarterly*, 66(2), 245–252. <https://doi.org/10.1177/19389655241256588>
- Kumar, J., Rani, V., Rani, G., & Rani, M. (2024). Does individuals' age matter? A comparative study of Generation X and Generation Y on green housing purchase intention. *Property Management*, 42(4), 507–522. <https://doi.org/10.1108/pm-08-2023-0081>
- Liu, Y., Wang, X., & Chen, Y. (2025). Does inconsistency between influencer-generated and user-generated content hurt brands? The role of perceived content credibility. *Psychology & Marketing*, 42(9), 2444–2472. <https://doi.org/10.1002/mar.22240>
- Malik, I., Raza, M., Hadi, N., Khan, M., & Hameed, F. (2023). Social commerce constructs and purchase intention on social commerce sites: Investigating the role of affective and cognitive attitudes in managing digital marketing challenges. *Management & Marketing*, 18(S1), 474–495. <https://doi.org/10.2478/mmcks-2023-0026>



- Nekmahmud, M., & Fekete-Farkas, M. (2020). Why not green marketing? Determinants of consumers' intention toward green purchase decisions in a developing nation. *Sustainability*, 12(19), Article 7880. <https://doi.org/10.3390/su12197880>
- Nguyen, C., Nguyen, T., & Luu, V. (2022). Relationship between influencer marketing and purchase intention: Focusing on Vietnamese Gen Z consumers. *Independent Journal of Management & Production*, 13(2), 810–828. <https://doi.org/10.14807/ijmp.v13i2.1603>
- Octaviani, R., Sucherly, S., Prabowo, H., & Sari, D. (2023). Determinants of Indonesian Gen Z's purchase behavior on online travel platforms: Extending the UTAUT model. *Innovative Marketing*, 19(4), 54–65. [https://doi.org/10.21511/im.19\(4\).2023.05](https://doi.org/10.21511/im.19(4).2023.05)
- Táborecká-Petrovičová, J., Rajić, T., Vinczeová, M., & Kaputa, V. (2023). Attitudes and actual buying behaviour of sustainable clothes from the perspective of female generations in Slovakia. *Marketing and Management of Innovations*, 14(3), 125–133. <https://doi.org/10.21272/mmi.2023.3-11>
- Vrontis, D., Makrides, A., Christofi, M., & Thrassou, A. (2021). Social media influencer marketing: A systematic review, integrative framework and future research agenda. *International Journal of Consumer Studies*, 45(4), 617–644. <https://doi.org/10.1111/ijcs.12647>
- Yin, H., Huang, X., & Zhou, G. (2024). An empirical investigation into the impact of social media fitness videos on users' exercise intentions. *Behavioral Sciences*, 14(3), Article 157. <https://doi.org/10.3390/bs14030157>

